

“It’s Okay Not to Have It All Figured Out”



When I asked Tessa Jacquerot what her post-grad plans were, she laughed and said, “I hate that question.” As a UC Berkeley senior from Santa Cruz finishing her Econ & Data Science degree, she explained that everyone on campus feels pressure to constantly achieve and have a clear plan, but she’s learning that it’s okay not to. “There’s this pressure to always be doing something, to always be going somewhere,” she said. For Tessa, the best part of college has been how easy it is to meet people. “You just bump into people here,” she reflected. “You’ll see someone on Sproul, at Trader Joe’s, or walking home from class.” She worries that post-grad life won’t have those same spontaneous moments of connection. “Afterward, you have to be so intentional about meeting anyone.” During our relaxed Zoom conversation, she spoke about wanting to find balance: being ambitious but also happy. “I don’t want to end up in a job I hate just because it sounds impressive,” she said. Her plan is to apply to jobs through winter, ideally something remote in California, maybe San Diego or Santa Barbara, and travel in the summer. Though she admits the unknown can feel scary, she’s found peace in knowing that life doesn’t have to follow one path. “The goal in life is subjective,” she said. “Everyone’s path looks different, and that’s okay.”

Moral: In college connection feels effortless, but as students face post-grad life, they long for new ways to find that same sense of community and calm.

“From Go-Go-Go to Now What?”



London Vidaurri, a recent UC Berkeley graduate who finished her Film degree in just three years, described her college experience as fast-paced, social, and full of possibility. “I dipped my toes into everything,” she said, recalling her time in clubs, Greek life, and constant networking events. “At Berkeley, you’re always running into people. You go to Strada for coffee, and you bump into so many people you know.” But once she graduated, that sense of effortless connection disappeared. “It’s so much harder to make friends now,” she said. “I miss that girlhood from my sorority and just having people my age around.” After traveling for a bit post-grad, she admitted that the transition was harder than she expected. “I was crashing out because I didn’t have a job,” she explained. “I thought graduating from Berkeley would give me a boost, but I couldn’t even get past the first round of applications.” She laughed about eventually landing a job through someone she met at a bar. “It’s all about who you know,” she said. “Mass applying on LinkedIn doesn’t work.” Though she feels more settled now, London still visits campus often. “I miss the energy of it,” she said. “It’s hard to get used to not having structure.” When asked what she wished existed, she said she’d love a platform that connects recent grads who are figuring things out, without the pressure of comparison. “LinkedIn feels fake,” she said. “I wish there was something real, something that makes slowing down feel okay.”

Moral: When the Berkeley hustle fades, finding connection and purpose again means slowing down and redefining success for yourself.